

AFI NEW BUCHAREST (AFI GREEN CITY)



Visual: project identity graphic generated from the supplied project list. Official project images are available through the source links below.

Why is this project a best practice?

Challenge

The project addresses the difficulty of scaling low-energy and healthy-building principles beyond a single dwelling. It had to combine density or phased delivery with reliable energy performance, good indoor conditions, landscape quality, mobility and construction cost, while keeping the sustainability measures practical for many future occupants.

Solution

The response combines an energy performance certificate reported at 105.3 kWh/m²/year for the certified phase; a planned residential community with landscaped areas, playgrounds and everyday services; and location and mobility planning intended to reduce car dependence through proximity to public transport. These measures were brought together through an integrated design approach and, where applicable, the Green Homes, nZEB or Passive House performance framework.

Replicability

The approach can be scaled through repeatable specifications for envelope, MEP systems, materials, commissioning, mobility and landscape. Replication is strongest when the developer applies the same measurable requirements to every phase and verifies them at handover, rather than treating certification as a one-off design exercise.

Key facts and figures

Location	Bulevardul Laminorului 138B, Bucharest, Romania
Building use / function	Multi-family residential development

AFI New Bucharest (AFI Green City) is a new build project in Bulevardul Laminorului 138B, Bucharest, Romania. It functions as multi-family residential development. Its main best-

practice contribution is A large developer-led residential scheme that integrates certification, amenities and mobility at neighbourhood scale. The documented strategy brings together an energy performance certificate reported at 105.3 kWh/m²/year for the certified phase, a planned residential community with landscaped areas, playgrounds and everyday services, and location and mobility planning intended to reduce car dependence through proximity to public transport. Public figures refer to the certified phase and should be verified against the final developer handover documentation. Public-source research was reviewed in July 2026; data that vary by phase are explicitly flagged in this sheet.

What was done differently?

1. Performance concept - An energy performance certificate reported at 105.3 kWh/m²/year for the certified phase.
2. Integrated systems and operation - A planned residential community with landscaped areas, playgrounds and everyday services.
3. Wider value - Location and mobility planning intended to reduce car dependence through proximity to public transport.

What was achieved?

Impact

Environmental impact: The project reduces energy and associated emissions primarily by lowering demand and then using efficient or renewable systems. Its material, landscape, waste or mobility measures add benefits beyond operational energy where documented. A verified whole-life carbon assessment was not publicly available, so the impact is described qualitatively unless a source provides a specific figure.

Economic impact: Lower energy demand can reduce utility exposure and improve long-term operating-cost predictability. Standardised high-performance specifications and third-party certification can also support quality assurance, market value and access to green-finance products. Public sources do not provide a complete investment, payback or life-cycle-cost analysis for this project.

Social impact: The main social benefits are stable indoor temperatures, better air quality, daylight and acoustic comfort, together with safer and more attractive shared or outdoor spaces where these form part of the project. The project also raises market awareness by making high-performance housing visible to residents, designers, contractors and investors.

Key Learnings

Success factors: Key success factors are an integrated design process, a clear performance framework, early coordination of envelope and building services, selection of competent suppliers, quality control during construction and commissioning. Transparent documentation and communication with occupants are essential to preserve the intended performance in use.

Lessons for replication: Replication should start with an energy and comfort target, not a catalogue of technologies. Design teams should verify thermal bridges, airtightness, ventilation, controls and renewable sizing together; record assumptions by project phase; commission systems; and monitor early operation. Where public figures differ by phase, the final as-built dataset must become the single source of truth.